

Meru मेरु

A personal AI assistant that runs entirely on your own computer.

In some Eastern traditions, Meru is the cosmic mountain that the sun, moon and stars turn around.

v0.4.18 · October 2026 · aarora79.github.io/meru

github.com/aarora79/meru
Scan for the code

WHY

Your most useful data is the data you'd least like to send away

- Years of notes, a full inbox, a calendar and folders of documents hold the answers to most of your questions.
- The assistants that could help want to read all of it in somebody else's data center.
- Every question costs money, needs an account, and depends on a service that can change its price, its terms or its model.

THE IDEA

Bring the AI to your data, on a machine you control

It runs at home

Open-weight models run on your own Mac or Linux machine. Your questions and files stay there.

No cloud model, at all

Meru's code has no path to a cloud AI model, not even one switched off.

No account, no bill

No sign-up and no API key. A question costs the electricity your computer uses.

You can look inside

Your files are the source of truth. Memories and skills are Markdown files you can read and edit.

You choose the tools

Mail, calendar and the web start switched off. Meru asks before anything that sends or changes.

Free and open

Apache License 2.0. Read the code, run it, change it.

WHAT IT DOES

Ask about everything you keep

Your files

Notes, documents, PDFs and code in the folders you pick, searched by words and by meaning. Each answer names its files.

Mail and calendar

Search Gmail, list your events, read Drive files. Sending a mail or changing an event asks you first.

Your notes

An Obsidian vault, and on a Mac, your Apple Notes, read as they are at that moment.

The web

Private search through SearXNG on your machine, and whole pages read when an answer needs them.

Your pictures

Find a photo by describing it, or one like a picture you attach. A model that can see reads receipts and screenshots.

Your voice new in v0.4.18

Press the microphone, speak, check the words, press Send. Whisper hears you on your Mac.

WHAT IT DOES

An assistant that learns who you are

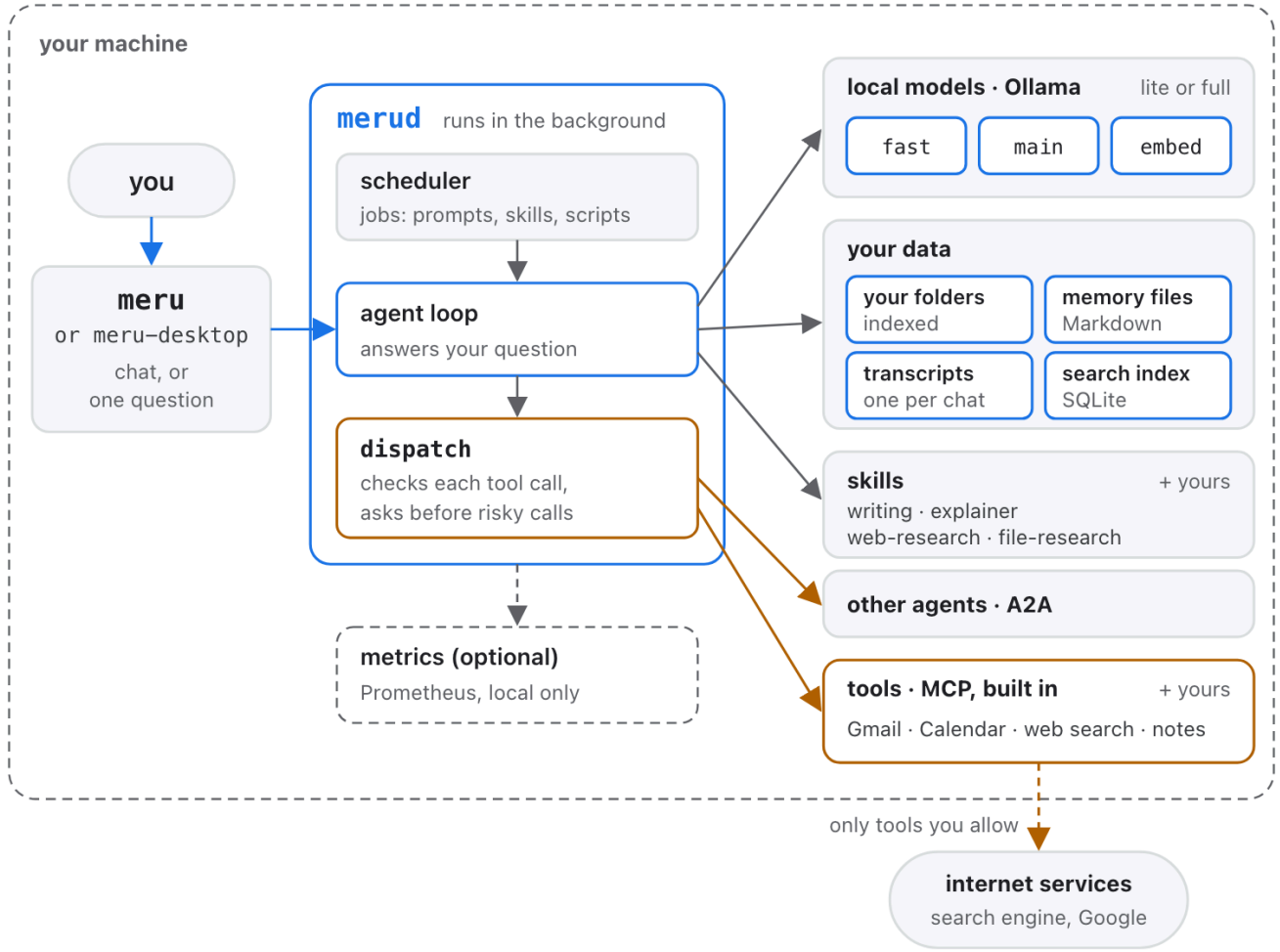
- **Memory.** Meru saves what it learns about you as small Markdown files, which you can read, fix or delete.
- **Skills.** Instructions it loads when a question needs them: writing, explaining, researching the web or your files.
- **Where it looks.** One switch keeps a question to your files, your mail and calendar, the web, or no tools at all.

Questions people ask

- "What did I write about the garden plan last spring?"
- "Summarize this week's mail from the school."
- "Find the photo of the receipt from the hardware store."
- "Draft a reply to that thread and say I can make it."

Meru.app on a Mac, `meru chat` in any terminal.

HOW IT WORKS



Everything inside the dashed line runs on your machine

- **Ollama**, a free program, runs the models.
- **merud** runs in the background and does the work.
- **Meru.app** and **meru** are the windows onto it.
- Only tools you allow reach the internet, and every call goes through one checkpoint.

HOW WELL

Good answers, sized to your Mac's memory

Mac memory	Answer model	Tasks passed	First token	Last token
under 32 GB	MiniCPM5-2B	68%	11.6 s	13.1 s
32 to 47 GB	Gemma 4 26B	80%	17.6 s	18.3 s
48 to 63 GB	Qwen 3.6 35B, 4-bit	89%	5.6 s	10.4 s
64 GB or more	Qwen 3.6 35B, 8-bit	89%	4.1 s	6.5 s

50 tasks, each run three times: direct questions, searches of your files, tasks with one tool or several, conversations, and honesty checks. Medians on a Mac Studio (M4 Max, 64 GB), routing, search and tool calls included. The installer picks the model for your Mac.

PRIVACY

Privacy you can check, not just trust

Stays on your machine

- Your questions and Meru's answers
- Your files, notes and the search index
- Your memories and chat history
- Your voice: no recording is ever kept
- The models, and every word they write

Leaves only when you allow it

- Search words, through the search engine on your machine
- Calls to services you connect, such as Gmail
- Public web pages Meru reads; it asks before any address no search or question of yours gave
- Every tool call is logged: `meru log` shows them all

FOR ORGANIZATIONS

A private AI workspace on every desk

The same design that keeps one person's data home keeps a team's documents inside the organization: on the managed machine, with no AI provider in the path.

No data processor

No prompt or document goes to a model provider, so there is no AI vendor to assess or contract with.

Deny by default

A new tool or agent does nothing until configuration names it, tool by tool.

An audit trail

Every tool call, its approval and outcome, in a log on the machine.

FOR ORGANIZATIONS

Controls a security team can check

Control	How Meru does it
Tools	Each tool is on, asks first, or off, in one config file. Sending, deleting or changing asks the user every time.
Network	The assistant connects only to its own machine, except to servers marked remote and to public pages it reads, never to private addresses.
Secrets	API keys live in one file only the user can read. They never reach the model, the logs or the history.
Telemetry	None leaves the machine, and Meru never checks for updates. Metrics go to a Prometheus you run, on the same machine.
Supply chain	Every program Meru installs is pinned by version and SHA-256 or image digest; CI signs a record of how Meru's speech server was built.
Enforcement	Policy tests in CI fail the build if code adds a cloud model, a second path to a tool, or a forbidden import.

FOR ORGANIZATIONS

Where it stands today

Ready now

- One person per machine, on a Mac with Apple silicon or an Ubuntu machine, where an NVIDIA card picks the model
- Open source under Apache 2.0: audit it, fork it, build it yourself
- Checks every download against the release's checksums, and runs offline once the models are down
- Fits a pilot: a team with sensitive documents on managed Macs

Not there yet

- It is pre-alpha software, built by one person
- No central policy, single sign-on or fleet management
- Windows should work but isn't tested
- Builds aren't signed by Apple yet, so macOS permissions need granting again after updates

TRY IT

On a Mac or Linux in a few minutes

In a window

Download the Mac installer from the latest release, open it, and open "Install Meru.app". It walks through eleven steps and says what each downloads first.

In Terminal

```
curl -fsSL https://github.com/aarora79/meru/releases/latest/download/install.sh | bash
```

It checks every download against the release's checksums, and asks before each step.

Needs a Mac with Apple silicon and 16 GB of memory, and about 2 GB of models to start. On Ubuntu, the same line with `install-linux.sh` installs Meru, the desktop app and a systemd service. Windows: the running guide on GitHub.

WHAT NEXT

Where Meru goes from here

- **It acts before you ask.** Scheduled jobs and a morning brief that lands without a question (v0.5).
- **Live voice.** Words appear as you speak, not after you stop.
- **Signed builds.** So macOS keeps its permissions across updates.
- **Windows.** A service and a full test pass.

We build in the open. Contributions are welcome: the issue list on GitHub says what's planned, and the first outside contribution is already in review.



Thank you

Your assistant, your machine, your data.

We build in the open, and we're happy to accept contributions: **see the issue list** on GitHub.

github.com/aarora79/meru
Scan for the code

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